

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Indirect questions with ob**

Sections covered: Nebensätze mit ob, Indirekte Fragen, Typische Redenmittel für indirekte Fragen, Wortstellung in Nebensätzen

LESSON SUMMARY

This lesson focused on practicing indirect questions using 'ob' (whether/if). Students learned to transform direct yes/no questions into subordinate clauses with correct word order (verb at the end). Various typical sentence starters were introduced including 'Ich frage mich, ob...', 'Ich überlege, ob...', 'Ich möchte wissen, ob...', 'Darf ich Sie fragen, ob...', and 'Ich habe keine Ahnung, ob...'. The lesson emphasized fluency through repetition of these structures, incorporating previously learned grammar like reflexive verbs and formal structures.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **die Sorge** — concern [A2]
- **unterwegs** — on the way, out and about [A2]
- **mindestens** — at least [B1]
- **höchstens** — at most [B1]
- **das Gegenteil** — opposite [B1]
- **das Redenmittel** — phrase, means of speaking [B1]
- **überlegen** — to think about, to consider [B1]
- **sollen** — shall (asking for opinion/suggestion) [B1]
- **abfahren** — to depart, to leave [A2]
- **geöffnet** — open [A2]
- **geschlossen** — closed [A2]
- **parken** — to park [A2]
- **informieren** — to inform [B1]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Indirect questions with 'ob'

→ When transforming a yes/no question into an indirect question, use 'ob' (whether/if) to introduce the subordinate clause. The conjugated verb moves to the end of the clause. Common sentence starters include 'Ich frage mich, ob...', 'Ich weiß nicht, ob...', 'Ich überlege, ob...', and 'Ich möchte wissen, ob...'

e.g. Hast du morgen Zeit? → Ich frage mich, ob du morgen Zeit hast.

e.g. Ist der Supermarkt sonntags geöffnet? → Ich weiß nicht, ob der Supermarkt sonntags geöffnet ist.

Subordinate clause word order

→ In German subordinate clauses (Nebensätze), the conjugated verb always moves to the final position of the clause. Subordinate clauses are dependent clauses that cannot stand alone and are introduced by subordinating conjunctions (such as dass, weil, wenn, ob, obwohl, als, bevor, nachdem, während, damit) or relative pronouns. The entire subordinate clause must be separated from the main clause by a comma. When a subordinate clause begins a sentence, it counts as position 1, so the main clause verb must come immediately after the comma (verb-comma-verb pattern).

e.g. Ich weiß nicht, ob der Zug um 10 Uhr abfährt. (I don't know if the train departs at 10 o'clock.) - Simple present tense with separable verb, showing conjunction + subject + time expression + verb at end with prefix attached.

e.g. Er sagt, dass er gestern das Buch gelesen hat. (He says that he read the book yesterday.) - Perfect tense showing: conjunction + subject + time + object + participle + auxiliary at very end.

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Mach dir keine Sorgen** — Don't worry (*Reassuring someone, telling them not to be concerned*)
- **Es ist mir egal** — I don't care / It doesn't matter to me (*Expressing indifference about something*)
- **Ich frage mich, ob...** — I wonder if/whether... (*Introducing an indirect question expressing uncertainty or curiosity*)
- **Ich überlege, ob...** — I'm thinking about whether... / I'm considering whether... (*Expressing that you are in the process of deciding something*)
- **Ich möchte wissen, ob...** — I would like to know if/whether... (*Politely asking for information*)
- **Ich habe keine Ahnung, ob...** — I have no idea if/whether... (*Expressing complete lack of knowledge about something*)
- **Darf ich Sie fragen, ob...** — May I ask you whether... (*Very polite way to ask a question, formal situations*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Indirect questions with 'ob').

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Indirect questions with 'ob'. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more

- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence